

RACHEL RELOX

Product Owner | Product Discovery & Agile Delivery | SAFe RTE, Agilist & SSM Certified

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product Owner with 5+ years in stakeholder-facing, backlog-owning roles (22+ years in software delivery overall) who partners with designers and end users during product discovery, then carries that vision through Agile delivery to launch. Shipped 3 flagship features live at Alaska Airlines — including a consumer-facing app beta on the Apple App Store and Google Play shaped through direct designer collaboration and user testing, and a Bank of America system integration coordinated end-to-end with DevOps. Owned the backlog and product vision behind a zero-defect release named Cognizant's Project of the Year. Named Cognizant's Circle of Excellence Manager of the Year (2025), the company's top honor across every function and business unit.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Discovery: Identifying product needs, partnering with designers, supporting user testing, refining requirements before development

Product Ownership & Backlog Management: Product vision & roadmap ownership, backlog prioritization, MVP definition & scoping, user story & acceptance criteria writing, OKR-driven prioritization

Agile Ceremonies & Delivery: Sprint planning, daily stand-ups, backlog refinement, sprint reviews, retrospectives, PI Planning, BDD / outside-in development

Technical & Cross-Functional Collaboration: System integrations, APIs, and migrations coordinated with DevOps teams; cross-functional collaboration with developers, designers, and QA

Stakeholder & Strategic Alignment: Stakeholder workshop facilitation, expectation management, roadmap alignment to business and market priorities, budget/scope/risk/dependency management

Tools: Jira, Azure DevOps (ADO), Confluence, Miro, Figma, Power BI, Microsoft Office, Microsoft Copilot 365, Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Shaped a consumer-facing mobile app's product direction** from discovery through launch, as measured by a successful beta release on the Apple App Store and Google Play, by partnering with designers, supporting user testing, and owning planning through launch end-to-end.
- **Delivered a zero-defect production release** as Product Owner for CBRE, as measured by 100% clean deployment, by owning product vision, roadmap, and backlog end-to-end — the win named Cognizant's Project of the Year.
- **Coordinated a Bank of America system integration** end-to-end, as measured by a clean production release with zero major post-launch defects, by managing scope, DevOps dependencies, and stakeholder alignment from planning through launch.
- **Earned Cognizant's top company-wide recognition**, as measured by the 2025 Circle of Excellence Manager of the Year award across every function and business unit, by driving product ownership and stakeholder leadership across every engagement.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Cognizant / Cognizant Softvision

Official Cognizant title: Project Manager (Mar 2023), promoted to Senior Project Manager (Jul 2025). Titles below reflect client-engagement assignments.

Product Owner

Feb 2026 – May 2026

CogniVerse — Internal Innovation & Bench Management | Philippines, Hybrid

- Refined product requirements before development, as measured by a fully groomed, prioritized backlog ready for sprint execution, by partnering with designers and stakeholders during discovery to shape the Cogniverse associate-engagement platform.
- Signed off the platform for release, as measured by 100% compliance with defined acceptance criteria, by personally validating delivered output and user flows against each story before deployment.
- Delivered 3 proof-of-concept products for an internal AI showcase, as measured by successful live demos of all three, by applying Spec-Driven Development across each build.

Product Owner

Nov 2023 – Feb 2026

Client: Alaska Airlines (Aviation) | US-based, Remote

- Shaped a consumer-facing mobile app's product direction from discovery through launch, as measured by a successful beta release on the Apple App Store and Google Play, by partnering with designers, supporting user testing, and carrying Scrum Master, QA Lead, and Product Owner responsibilities on the greenfield build.
- Coordinated a Bank of America system integration end-to-end, as measured by a clean production release with zero major post-launch defects, by managing scope, DevOps dependencies, and stakeholder alignment through planning to launch.
- Owned the Loyalty tower's product backlog through 3 PM transitions, as measured by zero delivery gaps, by grooming and prioritizing stories, writing acceptance criteria, and running sprint planning, backlog refinement, and reviews.
- Closed every backlog gap before sprint commitment, as measured by 100% Definition-of-Ready compliance, by partnering with designers and analyzing user-journey and user-testing feedback during refinement to surface and write missing stories.
- Stabilized every major go-live, as measured by contained issue volume through hypercare, by personally leading real-time issue triage and stakeholder communication.
- Kept PI Planning on schedule while the PM covered two teams simultaneously, as measured by zero missed planning commitments, by pre-aligning priorities with the PM and representing scope to the Scrum team.

Delivery Manager

Mar 2023 – Sep 2023

Client: BDO (Banking & Insurance) | Philippines, Hybrid

- Coordinated system integration and API delivery within BDO's formal API COE governance framework, as measured by clean stage-to-stage handoffs, by managing Dev Pods and DevOps teams through design, development, and release.
- Hit 100% of scheduled release dates, as measured by on-time deployment approvals across the engagement, by coordinating audit-ready documentation across Release, DevOps, and QA.

Product Owner

Aug 2022 – Dec 2022

Client: CBRE (Real Estate) | US-based, Remote

- Delivered a zero-defect production release, as measured by 100% clean deployment, by owning product vision, roadmap, and backlog end-to-end — work named Cognizant's Project of the Year.
- Got 100% of user stories to sprint-ready, as measured by BDD-validated acceptance criteria across the backlog, by running stakeholder workshops, partnering with designers, and leading requirements discovery directly with developers and QA.

Scrum Master

Feb 2022 – May 2022

Client: ENSEK (Finance & Payment Extension) | UK-based, Remote

- Got 100% of the backlog ordered and sprint-ready, as measured by Definition of Ready compliance every planning cycle, by facilitating backlog refinement and negotiating MVP scope directly with the Scrum Team, BA, and Product Owner.

Prior Experience

- **Software Development Manager — GHL Systems Berhad** (FinTech) | Nov 2021 – Feb 2022 — led 3 development teams to successful client UAT sign-off on a P2M application suite.
- **Senior Application Team Lead & Senior Software Developer — AIG Shared Services** (Insurance, US-based) | Sep 2009 – Apr 2021 — moved a 7-9 person team from Waterfall to Agile; built proof-of-concept applications that shaped product roadmap decisions over a 9-year tenure.

EDUCATION

- **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science** — STI College, 2003

CERTIFICATIONS

- Scrum Product Owner Accredited Certification (SPOAC) — International Scrum Institute, 2021
- Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) — Scrum.org, 2022
- Certified SAFe 5 Scrum Master (SSM) — Scaled Agile, Inc., 2026 (renewed)
- AI-Empowered SAFe Release Train Engineer (RTE) 6.0 — Scaled Agile, Inc., 2026
- Certified AI-Empowered SAFe Agilist — Scaled Agile, Inc., 2026 (renewed)
- Scrum Master (SMAC) & Scaled Scrum Expert (SSEAC) Accredited Certifications — International Scrum Institute, 2021